

1.1 Vectors, matrices and the operations we use

This chapter works in $\mathbb{R}^n$ and with real matrices only. It fixes the conventions, states the results later chapters cite, and proves them. A reader who already knows linear algebra can go straight to the results that are specific to statistics: generalized inverses (Section 1.3 and Section 1.4), Schur complements and the Woodbury identity (Section 1.6), nonnegative definite matrices (Section 1.7), conditioning (Section 1.8) and idempotent matrices (Section 1.9). Orthogonal projections, the geometric heart of least squares, get only the minimum here. Chapter 6 develops them.

1.1.1 Conventions

An $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A} = (a_{ij})$ has m rows and n columns. We write $\mathbf{A} = [\mathbf{a}_1, \dots, \mathbf{a}_n]$ for its columns and $\mathbf{a}_{(i)}^\top$ for its i th row. A **vector** is always a column, so $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is an $n \times 1$ matrix and $\mathbf{x}^\top$ is a row. Bold upright letters denote vectors and matrices, and italic letters denote scalars. The special matrices we use constantly are the identity $\mathbf{I}_n$, the zero matrix $\mathbf{0}$, the vector of ones $\mathbf{1}_n$, the matrix of ones $\mathbf{J}_n = \mathbf{1}_n \mathbf{1}_n^\top$, and the coordinate vectors $\mathbf{e}_1, \dots, \mathbf{e}_n$, the columns of $\mathbf{I}_n$. Subscripts giving sizes are dropped when the size is clear. $\text{diag}(d_1, \dots, d_n)$ is the diagonal matrix with the given diagonal entries. A square matrix is **symmetric** if $\mathbf{A}^\top = \mathbf{A}$, *upper triangular* if $a_{ij} = 0$ for $i > j$, and *lower triangular* if $\mathbf{A}^\top$ is upper triangular.

The **transpose** satisfies $(\mathbf{A}^\top)^\top = \mathbf{A}$, $(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})^\top = \mathbf{A}^\top + \mathbf{B}^\top$ and, most usefully,

$$(\mathbf{AB})^\top = \mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top. \quad (1.1.1)$$

1.1.2 Products as linear combinations

If $\mathbf{A}$ is $m \times n$ and $\mathbf{B}$ is $n \times q$, the (i, j) entry of $\mathbf{AB}$ is $\sum_k a_{ik} b_{kj}$. Three equivalent readings of the product carry most of the arguments in this book:

$$\mathbf{Ab} = \sum_{j=1}^n b_j \mathbf{a}_j, \quad \mathbf{AB} = [\mathbf{Ab}_1, \dots, \mathbf{Ab}_q], \quad \mathbf{AB} = \sum_{k=1}^n \mathbf{a}_k \mathbf{b}_{(k)}^\top. \quad (1.1.2)$$

The first says that $\mathbf{Ab}$ combines the columns of $\mathbf{A}$, with weights taken from $\mathbf{b}$. The second says that each column of $\mathbf{AB}$ is such a combination. The third writes a product as a sum of n rank-one matrices (outer products), and is the form in which spectral and singular value decompositions are usually used. Transposing the first reading shows that each row of $\mathbf{AB}$ is a combination of the rows of $\mathbf{B}$.

Matrices partitioned into conformable blocks multiply as if the blocks were scalars, as long as the order of factors is kept:

$$\begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{A}_{11} & \mathbf{A}_{12} \\ \mathbf{A}_{21} & \mathbf{A}_{22} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{B}_{11} & \mathbf{B}_{12} \\ \mathbf{B}_{21} & \mathbf{B}_{22} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{A}_{11}\mathbf{B}_{11} + \mathbf{A}_{12}\mathbf{B}_{21} & \mathbf{A}_{11}\mathbf{B}_{12} + \mathbf{A}_{12}\mathbf{B}_{22} \\ \mathbf{A}_{21}\mathbf{B}_{11} + \mathbf{A}_{22}\mathbf{B}_{21} & \mathbf{A}_{21}\mathbf{B}_{12} + \mathbf{A}_{22}\mathbf{B}_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Multiplication is associative and distributive but not commutative, and $\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{0}$ does not force $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$ or $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{0}$. The **Hadamard product** $\mathbf{A} \circ \mathbf{B} = (a_{ij}b_{ij})$ multiplies entrywise. It appears only occasionally.

1.1.3 Inner products, lengths and the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality

The **inner product** of $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is $\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle = \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} = \sum_i u_i v_i$, and the **Euclidean norm** is $\|\mathbf{u}\| = (\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{u})^{1/2}$. The entries of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ are the inner products of the columns of $\mathbf{A}$, and those of $\mathbf{AA}^\top$ are the inner products of its rows. In particular

$$\sum_{i,j} a_{ij}^2 = \sum_j \|\mathbf{a}_j\|^2, \quad (1.1.3)$$

so $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$ forces every column to be zero, that is, $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$. The square root of Eq. 1.1.3 is the **Frobenius norm** $\|\mathbf{A}\|_F$.

Proposition 1.1.1 — Cauchy–Schwarz

For $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $(\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v})^2 \leq (\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{u})(\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{v})$, with equality iff one vector is a multiple of the other. Consequently $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\| \leq \|\mathbf{u}\| + \|\mathbf{v}\|$.

Proof. If $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$ there is nothing to prove. Otherwise, the quadratic $q(t) = \|\mathbf{u} - t\mathbf{v}\|^2 = \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{u} - 2t \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} + t^2 \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{v}$ is nonnegative for all t , so its discriminant $4(\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v})^2 - 4(\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{u})(\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{v})$ is at most zero. Equality holds iff q has a real root, that is, iff $\mathbf{u} = t\mathbf{v}$ for some t . The triangle inequality follows by expanding $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\|^2$ and bounding the cross term. ■

1.1.4 Quadratic forms

A **quadratic form** in $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is a function $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{Ax} = \sum_{i,j} a_{ij} x_i x_j$. Since $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{Ax}$ is a scalar it equals its own transpose $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{x}$, so

$$\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{Ax} = \mathbf{x}^\top \left(\frac{1}{2} (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{A}^\top) \right) \mathbf{x}. \quad (1.1.4)$$

Every quadratic form therefore has a symmetric matrix, and that matrix is unique: if $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{Sx} = 0$ for all $\mathbf{x}$ with $\mathbf{S}$ symmetric, then taking $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{e}_i$ gives $s_{ii} = 0$, and $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{e}_i + \mathbf{e}_j$ gives $2s_{ij} = 0$. From now on we always take the matrix in a quadratic form to be symmetric.

Example. (Sums of squares as quadratic forms)

The sum of squared deviations of $\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ from its mean is

$$\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \bar{y})^2 = \mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y} - n\bar{y}^2 = \mathbf{y}^\top \left(\mathbf{I}_n - \frac{1}{n} \mathbf{J}_n \right) \mathbf{y},$$

because $n\bar{y}^2 = (\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{y})^2 / n = \mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{J}_n \mathbf{y} / n$. The **centring matrix** $\mathbf{I}_n - n^{-1} \mathbf{J}_n$ is symmetric and satisfies $(\mathbf{I}_n - n^{-1} \mathbf{J}_n)^2 = \mathbf{I}_n - n^{-1} \mathbf{J}_n$, because $\mathbf{J}_n^2 = n \mathbf{J}_n$. Every sum of squares in an analysis of variance is a quadratic form whose matrix has these two properties (Section 1.9).

1.1.5 Exercises

1.1.5.1 A. Check your understanding

Exercise A1.

Let $\mathbf{A}$ be $m \times n$ and let $\mathbf{D} = \text{diag}(d_1, \dots, d_n)$. Using Eq. 1.1.2, identify $\mathbf{A} \mathbf{e}_j$, $\mathbf{e}_i^\top \mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{e}_i^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{e}_j$, and show that $\mathbf{A} \mathbf{D}$ multiplies the j th column of $\mathbf{A}$ by d_j , while a diagonal matrix multiplying $\mathbf{A}$ on the left scales its rows. What are $\mathbf{A} \mathbf{1}_n$, $\mathbf{1}_m^\top \mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{1}_m^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{1}_n$?

Exercise A2.

Show the parallelogram law $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\|^2 + \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|^2 = 2\|\mathbf{u}\|^2 + 2\|\mathbf{v}\|^2$ and the polarization identity $\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} = \frac{1}{4}(\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\|^2 - \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|^2)$. Deduce that a matrix $\mathbf{T}$ with $\|\mathbf{T}\mathbf{x}\| = \|\mathbf{x}\|$ for every $\mathbf{x}$ satisfies $(\mathbf{T}\mathbf{u})^\top (\mathbf{T}\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v}$ for every $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}$: preserving lengths preserves angles.

Solution. Expanding $\|\mathbf{u} \pm \mathbf{v}\|^2 = \|\mathbf{u}\|^2 \pm 2\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} + \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$ and adding gives the first identity; subtracting gives the second. If $\mathbf{T}$ preserves lengths, then both norms on the right of the polarization identity are unchanged when $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}$ are replaced by $\mathbf{T}\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{T}\mathbf{v}$, since $\mathbf{T}\mathbf{u} \pm \mathbf{T}\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{T}(\mathbf{u} \pm \mathbf{v})$. So $(\mathbf{T}\mathbf{u})^\top (\mathbf{T}\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v}$.

Exercise A3.

Apply Proposition 1.1.1 with $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{1}_n$ and $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{y}$ to show $(\sum_i y_i)^2 \leq n \sum_i y_i^2$, with equality iff all the y_i are equal. Which property of the centring matrix of Example (Sums of squares as quadratic forms) is this?

Solution. Cauchy–Schwarz gives $(\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{y})^2 \leq (\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{1})(\mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y}) = n \mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y}$, with equality iff $\mathbf{y}$ is a multiple of $\mathbf{1}$. Rearranged, this says $\mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y} - n\bar{y}^2 \geq 0$, that is, the quadratic form of the centring matrix $\mathbf{I}_n - n^{-1} \mathbf{J}_n$ is nonnegative, and vanishes only for constant $\mathbf{y}$. The sum of squared deviations is never negative, and is zero only when there is no variation at all.

1.1.5.2 B. Practice

Exercise B1.

Let $\mathbf{A}$ be $n \times n$. (a) Show that $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{v} = 0$ for all $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{v}$ iff $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$. (b) Show that $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{x} = 0$ for all $\mathbf{x}$ iff $\mathbf{A}^\top = -\mathbf{A}$ (such an $\mathbf{A}$ is called *skew-symmetric*), and give a nonzero 2×2 example. (c) Deduce that two matrices define the same quadratic form iff they differ by a skew-symmetric matrix, so that the symmetric matrix in Eq. 1.1.4 is the only symmetric one.

Solution.

- (a) Taking $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{e}_i$ and $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{e}_j$ gives $a_{ij} = 0$; the converse is clear.
- (b) By Eq. 1.1.4, $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \mathbf{x}$ with $\mathbf{S} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{A}^\top)$ symmetric, and the uniqueness argument of this section shows that $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \mathbf{x} \equiv 0$ with $\mathbf{S}$ symmetric forces $\mathbf{S} = \mathbf{0}$, that is, $\mathbf{A}^\top = -\mathbf{A}$. Conversely $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{x} = \frac{1}{2} \mathbf{x}^\top (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{A}^\top) \mathbf{x} = 0$ for skew-symmetric $\mathbf{A}$. The matrix $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ is an example: it rotates $\mathbf{x}$ by a quarter turn, and a vector is orthogonal to its own rotation.
- (c) $\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{B} \mathbf{x}$ for all $\mathbf{x}$ iff $\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{B}$ is skew-symmetric by (b). The matrices with a given quadratic form are therefore $\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{K}$ with $\mathbf{K}$ skew-symmetric, and only $\mathbf{K} = \mathbf{0}$ gives a symmetric one, since a matrix that is both symmetric and skew-symmetric is zero.

Exercise B2.

Show that $\|\mathbf{AB}\|_F \leq \|\mathbf{A}\|_F \|\mathbf{B}\|_F$ whenever the product is defined, and in particular $\|\mathbf{Ax}\| \leq \|\mathbf{A}\|_F \|\mathbf{x}\|$. For fixed $\mathbf{A} \neq \mathbf{0}$, when does the second inequality become an equality?

Solution. The (i, j) entry of $\mathbf{AB}$ is $\mathbf{a}_{(i)}^\top \mathbf{b}_j$, so Proposition 1.1.1 gives $(\mathbf{a}_{(i)}^\top \mathbf{b}_j)^2 \leq \|\mathbf{a}_{(i)}\|^2 \|\mathbf{b}_j\|^2$. Summing over i and j and using Eq. 1.1.3 for the rows of $\mathbf{A}$ and the columns of $\mathbf{B}$,

$$\|\mathbf{AB}\|_F^2 \leq \left(\sum_i \|\mathbf{a}_{(i)}\|^2 \right) \left(\sum_j \|\mathbf{b}_j\|^2 \right) = \|\mathbf{A}\|_F^2 \|\mathbf{B}\|_F^2.$$

Taking $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{x}$ gives the second inequality. Equality there needs equality in Cauchy–Schwarz for every row, that is, every row of $\mathbf{A}$ is a multiple of $\mathbf{x}^\top$. So equality holds iff $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{c} \mathbf{x}^\top$ for some vector $\mathbf{c}$, and in particular only for $\mathbf{A}$ of rank one.

Exercise B3.

Let $\mathbf{X}$ be $n \times p$ with rows $\mathbf{x}_{(i)}^\top$, and let $\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Use the third reading in Eq. 1.1.2 to show

$$\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{x}_{(i)} \mathbf{x}_{(i)}^\top, \quad \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{y} = \sum_{i=1}^n y_i \mathbf{x}_{(i)}.$$

Deduce that deleting the i th observation subtracts $\mathbf{x}_{(i)} \mathbf{x}_{(i)}^\top$ and $y_i \mathbf{x}_{(i)}$, and that splitting the rows into groups adds the groups' cross-products. This is the form in which Example (Deleting an observation) updates a fit.

Solution. The columns of $\mathbf{X}^\top$ are the vectors $\mathbf{x}_{(i)}$ and the rows of $\mathbf{X}$ are the $\mathbf{x}_{(i)}^\top$, so the third reading of the product writes $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ as the sum of the outer products $\mathbf{x}_{(i)} \mathbf{x}_{(i)}^\top$. The same reading applied to $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{y}$, with $\mathbf{y}$ a single column, gives $\sum_i y_i \mathbf{x}_{(i)}$. Both are sums over observations of terms that involve one observation each, so removing an observation removes its term and pooling two groups adds their sums.

1.1.5.3 C. Going deeper

Exercise C1.

Prove Lagrange's identity

$$\left(\sum_i u_i^2\right)\left(\sum_i v_i^2\right) - \left(\sum_i u_i v_i\right)^2 = \sum_{i < j} (u_i v_j - u_j v_i)^2,$$

and read off from it a second proof of [Proposition 1.1.1](#) together with its equality case. Deduce that $\|\mathbf{u}\mathbf{v}^\top - \mathbf{v}\mathbf{u}^\top\|_F^2 = 2(\|\mathbf{u}\|^2\|\mathbf{v}\|^2 - (\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v})^2)$, and show that equality in the triangle inequality, $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\| = \|\mathbf{u}\| + \|\mathbf{v}\|$, holds iff one of the two vectors is a *nonnegative* multiple of the other.

Solution. Write the left-hand side as a double sum and symmetrize:

$$\sum_{i,j} u_i^2 v_j^2 - \sum_{i,j} u_i v_i u_j v_j = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i,j} (u_i^2 v_j^2 + u_j^2 v_i^2 - 2u_i v_j u_j v_i) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i,j} (u_i v_j - u_j v_i)^2,$$

and the terms with $i = j$ vanish while each pair $i \neq j$ is counted twice, which gives the sum over $i < j$. The right-hand side is nonnegative, so $(\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v})^2 \leq \|\mathbf{u}\|^2 \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$, with equality iff $u_i v_j = u_j v_i$ for all i, j , which for $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$ means $\mathbf{u} = (\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} / \|\mathbf{v}\|^2) \mathbf{v}$, a multiple of $\mathbf{v}$. The entries of $\mathbf{u}\mathbf{v}^\top - \mathbf{v}\mathbf{u}^\top$ are $u_i v_j - u_j v_i$, so its squared Frobenius norm is the full double sum, namely twice the sum over $i < j$.

For the triangle inequality, squaring $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\| = \|\mathbf{u}\| + \|\mathbf{v}\|$ gives $\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} = \|\mathbf{u}\| \|\mathbf{v}\|$, so Cauchy–Schwarz holds with equality and $\mathbf{u} = t\mathbf{v}$ for some t (or $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$). Then $\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} = t\|\mathbf{v}\|^2$ and $\|\mathbf{u}\| \|\mathbf{v}\| = |t| \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$, so $t \geq 0$. Conversely $\mathbf{u} = t\mathbf{v}$ with $t \geq 0$ gives $\|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}\| = (1 + t)\|\mathbf{v}\| = \|\mathbf{u}\| + \|\mathbf{v}\|$.

Exercise C2.

For $m \times n$ matrices put $\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle_F = \sum_{i,j} a_{ij} b_{ij}$, so that $\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{A} \rangle_F = \|\mathbf{A}\|_F^2$ by [Eq. 1.1.3](#). Show that this is the ordinary inner product of the two matrices read as vectors of length mn , so that [Proposition 1.1.1](#) gives $|\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle_F| \leq \|\mathbf{A}\|_F \|\mathbf{B}\|_F$. Now let $\mathbf{A}$ be square and write $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{S} + \mathbf{K}$ with $\mathbf{S} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{A}^\top)$ and $\mathbf{K} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{A}^\top)$. Show that $\langle \mathbf{S}_0, \mathbf{K}_0 \rangle_F = 0$ whenever $\mathbf{S}_0$ is symmetric and $\mathbf{K}_0$ is skew-symmetric, and deduce that $\mathbf{S}$ is the unique symmetric matrix closest to $\mathbf{A}$ in Frobenius norm. So the symmetrization in [Eq. 1.1.4](#) is not merely convenient: it drops exactly the part of $\mathbf{A}$ that is orthogonal to every symmetric matrix.

Solution. Listing the entries of a matrix in any fixed order turns $\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle_F$ into $\sum_k a_k b_k$ for the two resulting vectors, so all the properties of the Euclidean inner product, Cauchy–Schwarz among them, carry over.

If $\mathbf{S}_0^\top = \mathbf{S}_0$ and $\mathbf{K}_0^\top = -\mathbf{K}_0$, then relabelling the summation indices gives

$$\langle \mathbf{S}_0, \mathbf{K}_0 \rangle_F = \sum_{i,j} s_{ij} k_{ij} = \sum_{i,j} s_{ji} k_{ji} = \sum_{i,j} s_{ij} (-k_{ij}) = -\langle \mathbf{S}_0, \mathbf{K}_0 \rangle_F,$$

so the inner product is zero. Let $\mathbf{S}_0$ be any symmetric matrix. Then $\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{S}_0 = (\mathbf{S} - \mathbf{S}_0) + \mathbf{K}$ with the first term symmetric and the second skew-symmetric, so by the orthogonality just proved

$$\|\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{S}_0\|_F^2 = \|\mathbf{S} - \mathbf{S}_0\|_F^2 + \|\mathbf{K}\|_F^2 \geq \|\mathbf{K}\|_F^2 = \|\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{S}\|_F^2,$$

with equality iff $\mathbf{S}_0 = \mathbf{S}$. The decomposition $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{S} + \mathbf{K}$ is an orthogonal one, and $\mathbf{S}$ is the orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{A}$ onto the subspace of symmetric matrices, in the sense that [Chapter 6](#) develops for subspaces of $\mathbb{R}^n$.